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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: Challenges, Opportunities, and Coping Mechanisms of Student Exchange Asia (SEA) Teachers in the International Student Mobility Program of Capiz State University

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Program or Project has a component (if no, proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/Biological Sciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center							
(4) Site of implementation									
		Municipality/City:							
		Province:	Capiz						
		Region:	VI – Western Visayas						
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>		Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:								
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing								
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization								
(7) Sector/Commodity		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization Social Science							

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(9) Rationale

The increasing globalization of higher education has led to a surge in international student mobility programs, fostering cross-cultural exchange and academic collaboration. However, there remains more research focusing on the experiences of Student Exchange Asia (SEA) Teachers within these programs, particularly within the context of institutions like Capiz State University (CapSU). This proposal seeks to address this gap by investigating the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms of Southeast Asia exchange students participating in the international student mobility program at CapSU.

"Pre-Service Student Teacher Exchange in Southeast Asia" or SEA Teacher Project aims to provide opportunities for pre-service student teachers from Southeast Asian universities to have their teaching experiences (practicum) in other Southeast Asian countries. (<https://seateacher.seameo.org/>)

By understanding the challenges faced by Southeast Asia Exchange students, particularly within the context of CapSU's student mobility program, this research aims to identify barriers to participation and success. Addressing these challenges can foster a more inclusive and diverse academic environment, aligning with national goals of promoting equal access to quality education.

In today's interconnected world, the internationalization of education is critical for enhancing the country's global competitiveness. By investigating exchange students' experiences, the research can identify opportunities for improving the quality and attractiveness of Capiz State University's international student mobility initiatives. These can contribute to attracting a diverse pool of international students, fostering academic collaboration, and enhancing the university's reputation on the global stage.

By providing evidence-based insights into Southeast Asian exchange students' needs and experiences, policymakers and university administrators can make informed decisions regarding program development, resource allocation, and support services. The positive experiences of international students at Capiz State University can serve as ambassadors for the country, promoting its culture, values, and educational excellence on the global stage. By supporting Southeast Asia exchange students' academic and personal growth, Capiz State University prepares them to become future leaders and global citizens who can contribute positively to their home countries and the broader Southeast Asian region. It aligns with the country's vision for sustainable development and regional cooperation.

Moreover, this research fosters sustainable partnerships and collaboration between Capiz State University and Student Exchange Asia universities. By providing insights into the needs and experiences of SEA teachers, the research lays the groundwork for future collaboration and exchange initiatives that are mutually beneficial and sustainable. This contributes to advancing academic excellence, research collaboration, and institutional capacity building, benefiting CapSU and its international partners.

Capiz State University (CapSU) collaborates with the SEAMEO programs in the Philippines to facilitate international student mobility and cross-cultural exchange of the students. However, more research needs to be conducted on the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms experienced by Student Exchange Asia (SEA) Teachers participating in this program.

The research problem centers on the experiences of Southeast Asia exchange students participating in international student mobility programs at Capiz State University (CapSU). Specifically, the study investigates the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms these students encounter during their academic pursuits abroad. It encompasses a comprehensive exploration of the socio-cultural, academic, and personal factors that influence the exchange student experience, aiming to provide insights into how CapSU can better support and enhance the success of its international student mobility program.

The outcomes of the research will not only benefit Capiz State University but contribute to the advancement of national education goals and the country's strategic objectives in the international arena. Furthermore, the insights generated from the research have the potential to yield long-term societal and economic benefits by fostering a more inclusive, prosperous, and globally engaged society.

The target users, including educational institution policymakers and program administrators, will benefit from the insights gained; it enables them to make informed decisions and implement necessary changes to improve the program.

(9-A) Project Description

The Project provides a comprehensive understanding of the experiences of Student Exchange Teachers during their practicum or OJT activity abroad. It will also present the different strategies of the students to cope with different challenges they encountered throughout their teaching experiences. It will also assess CapSU's initiatives to participate in the global education scale. This paper will prepare the researcher to plan for an impact study.

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(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem

The study aims to investigate the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms experienced by SEA Teachers participating in the Student Exchange Asia (SEA) program within the International Student Mobility Program at Capiz State University (CapSU). Specifically, it seeks to understand the following questions:

1. What is the level of challenges experienced by SEA teachers as an entire group and in terms of language barriers, cultural adjustment difficulties, pedagogical disparities, and administrative hurdles?
2. What opportunities do SEA teachers perceive in their involvement in the program as an entire group and in terms of professional development, cross-cultural learning, research collaboration, and personal growth?
3. What are the coping mechanisms and strategies SEA teachers utilize to navigate the challenges associated with their participation in the program as an entire group and in terms of cultural sensitivity training, peer support networks, and self-care practices?
4. Are there significant differences between the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms of SEA Teachers with their participation in the program?
5. Are there significant associations among the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms of SEA Teachers?

(11) Review of Literature/Prior Art Search

The integration of international student mobility programs, such as the Student Exchange Asia (SEA) initiative, has become increasingly prevalent in higher education institutions worldwide. As educators engage in cross-cultural teaching experiences, they encounter various challenges and opportunities. This review examines existing literature concerning the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms encountered by teachers participating in international student mobility programs, focusing on the context of Capiz State University (CapSU) in the Philippines.

In the past five years, there has been a continued emphasis on internationalization in higher education, driven by globalization and the growing demand for globally competent graduates (Altbach & Knight, 2015). Institutions increasingly engage in international student mobility programs to enhance their global reputation and provide students with cross-cultural learning opportunities.

The seven priority areas issued by the SEAMEO council will work together to improve the quality of education in Southeast Asia in October 2014. One of the priority areas is "Revitalizing Teacher Education" to achieve quality education in the region. The SEAMEO Secretariat, fulfilling this mandate, has embarked on the "Pre-Service Student Teacher Exchange in Southeast Asia (SEA-Teacher Project) **project**". https://www.seameo.org/Main_programme/399

A SEA Teacher Project kn, known as "Pre-Service Student Teacher Exchange in Southeast Asia (SEA Teacher)," is a project that aims to provide various teaching opportunities for pre-service student teachers from universities in Southeast Asia to have their teaching experiences (practicum) in schools in Southeast Asia. According to SEAMEO, the seven priority areas for the eleven SEAMEO Member countries will work together to improve the quality of education in Southeast Asian countries by "**Revitalizing Teacher Education**" as one of the priority areas in building and strengthening the capacity of teachers in the region.

The student teachers are preferably the 4th-year pre-services students majoring in Math, Science, English, and preschool. The duration of this teaching practicum is one month. According to the SEAMEO, the student's roles and responsibilities are assigned weekly during the one-month practicum (to observe, assist in teaching, teach, and reflect). Furthermore, the host universities will provide mentors to supervise, assist, and monitor the pre-service students throughout the practicum period (<https://seateacher.seameo.org/>).

Since it started in 2016, the SEA-Teacher Student Exchange Program has been conducted for eight batches participated by 2,318 pre-service student teachers from 136 teacher colleges and universities in Indonesia, Malaysia, Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, and Japan. However, due to the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020, the 9th batch of the SEA-Teacher Student Exchange has been postponed for implementation from 2020 until 2023.

Participating in international teaching programs offers teachers valuable opportunities for professional development and cross-cultural learning (Ward, 2016). Exposure to diverse teaching methodologies, educational practices, and cultural perspectives enriches teachers' pedagogical skills and enhances their global competence.

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Institutions can implement professional development programs and support services to assist teachers in preparing for and coping with the challenges of international teaching assignments (Marginson & van Noorden, 2019). Pre-departure orientation, cultural competence training, and ongoing professional mentoring promote teacher resilience and well-being.

It has significantly changed how education is perceived and delivered, transcending national borders and fostering a globalized learning environment (Berg & Schwander, 2019). Research has shown that participation in international exchange programs can have a positive impact on student-teachers by expanding their cultural awareness, developing intercultural competencies, and enhancing their ability to effectively teach in diverse and multicultural classrooms (Goodwin, 2020)

International student exchange programs have emerged as a crucial component of the global education landscape. These programs facilitate students' movement across countries, allowing them to immerse themselves in different cultural, academic, and social contexts (Goldstein, 2022). The findings of the study conducted by Diem, Thinh, and Mung (2023) reveal that one of the most significant reasons for their participation was their desire to expand their international teaching networks and even foster meaningful connections with students and teachers from other countries. The insights in their study provide valuable guidance and information for educational institutions in developing effective strategies, initiatives, and support systems to optimize the participation, experiences, and satisfaction of student teachers participating in the program.

(12) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework

By integrating these theories into the study's framework, researchers can gain insights into the challenges faced by SEA teachers in international student mobility programs, explore the opportunities for personal and professional development, and identify effective coping mechanisms to support their adaptation and success in the host country. Developed by Pierre Bourdieu, Cultural Capital theory suggests that individuals from different cultural backgrounds possess varying degrees of cultural capital, influencing their success and adaptation in educational settings. It can help understand how teachers and students from different cultural backgrounds navigate challenges and opportunities in the international student mobility program (Bourdieu, P., 1986)

Proposed by Henri Tajfel and John Turner, Social Identity Theory explores how membership in social groups shapes an individual's sense of self and how this impacts their behavior and interactions with others. In the context of the study, it can shed light on how teachers' social identities influence their experiences and coping mechanisms in the student exchange program (Tajfel et al.; J. C., 1986).

Social Exchange Theory provides a theoretical basis for understanding the challenges and opportunities experienced by SEA teachers in the international student mobility program. This theory suggests that an individual engages in social relationships and interactions based on the expectation of maximizing rewards and minimizing costs. In the context of this study, SEA teachers may face various challenges, such as cultural adjustment difficulties, language barriers, pedagogical disparities, and administrative hurdles. The theory helps explain the motivations and expectations of SEA teachers in participating in the program and how they perceive the costs and benefits associated with these challenges (Emerson, R.M., 1976).

Coping Theory can provide insights into SEA teachers' coping mechanisms in response to the challenges they face in the international student mobility program. This theory focuses on how individuals manage stress and adversity. In this study, SEA teachers may employ various coping strategies, such as problem-focused coping (taking actions to address challenges directly) or emotion-focused coping (managing emotional responses to challenges), to navigate language barriers, cultural adjustment difficulties, pedagogical disparities, and administrative hurdles (Folkman, S., 2013).

By grounding the study in these theoretical frameworks, researchers can comprehensively examine the challenges, opportunities, and coping mechanisms experienced by SEA teachers participating in the international student mobility program at Capiz State University.

Conceptual Framework:

Independent Variables

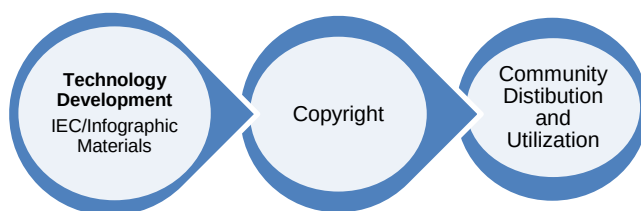
Dependent Variable

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(15) Expected Output (Indicate the specific products, processes, or services that the Project is expected to produce; quantify when possible)

EXPECTED OUTPUTS	DETAILS	TARGET
People Services	Survey/Interview SEA Teachers who participated in the Student Exchange Asia Program.	50
Publications	Publication of research paper	1
Patents/IP	File 1 copyrights for the developed IEC materials.	1
Places and Partnerships		5
Products		
Policy		
Impact on Social/ Economics	<i>Social Impact:</i> • Increase participation in international student mobility. • Increase the number of student exchanges. • Strengthen linkages with partner international institutions. • Promote cross-cultural awareness and respect for diversity. • Policymaking, administrative interventions/initiatives, and student support services • Enhance student affairs and services. • Support to the initiatives of Capiz State University for global education participation <i>Economic Impact:</i> • Increase employment opportunities.	

(16) Technology Transfer Activity Design



(17) Target Beneficiaries

- Capiz State University
- External Affairs and Lingakes Office
- OSA
- SEA Teachers
- SEAMEO
- Host Universities Abroad

(18) Personnel Requirement

Name	Role (Program, Project, Study Leader)	Field of Specialization
JEZEL S. APOCERO	Study Leader	Social Studies

Percent time devoted to the Program/ Project/ Study

Program/Project Leader (in hours):

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Program/Project Members (in hours):

(19) Budgetary Requirement

SOURCES OF EXPENSES	Quantity	Amount (CapSU)
A. <i>Personnel Services (For studies needed the <u>Research Assistant</u>, informant/s, guide)</i>		
B. <i>Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE)</i>		
▪ Transportation allowance		20,000
▪ Meal Allowance		10,000
▪ Focus Group Discussion expenses	8-10	20,000
▪ Supplies (bond papers, pens, kits)		10,000
▪ Communication Allowance (Mobile phone and internet Load)	12 mos. x 1000	12,000
▪ Online Platform subscription (ZOOM, Microsoft Teams)	12 mos. x 1000	12,000
▪ Printing (modules, brochures, invitations, tarps)		15,000
C. <i>Capital Outlay</i>		
Total		Php. 99,000

(20) Literature Cited

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<https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203505984-16>

(21) Capsule Curriculum Vitae

CURRICULUM VITAE

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PRESENT DESIGNATION:

Academic Rank: Assistant Professor IV

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Designations: OSA Chairperson (2017 - present)
GAD Focal Person (2017-2019)

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND:

Doctorate Degree: Doctor of Education - Major In Social Science Education (2017-to date)
Filamer Christian University

Master's Degree: Master of Arts in Teaching Major in Social Science (2014 – 2017)
Filamer Christian University

Academic Distinction: BENE MERITUS Award: Outstanding in Research Presentation

College: Bachelor of Secondary Education major in Social Studies (2008-2012)

Capiz State University Dumarao Satellite College

Award: Best in Research (Paper and Poster) Regional Level